

Ankit Raj

Senior Cloud Solution Architect - Azure AI, Infrastructure & Data

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Cloud Solution Architect with 10+ years of experience leading strategic technical engagements and delivering end-to-end cloud and AI solutions for large-scale enterprise customers across automotive, fashion, and financial services industries. Trusted technical advisor to executive stakeholders - partnering with C-level leaders and engineering teams to design secure, scalable, and resilient Azure architectures using CAF and Well-Architected Framework (WAF). Deep expertise across Azure AI, Applications, Infrastructure, and Data with hands-on delivery in Azure AI Foundry, App Services, Databricks, GitHub, Kubernetes (AKS), and Terraform. Proven track record of driving measurable business impact - 35% cloud cost optimisation, 70% latency reduction, and 99.9% platform reliability for 200+ product teams. AWS & Azure Certified with a growth mindset and passion for mentoring, knowledge sharing, and thought leadership.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Cloud Architecture	Architecture Design Sessions, Well-Architected Reviews (WAF), Cloud Adoption Framework (CAF), Migration Planning, Technical Advisory
Azure Services	Azure AI Foundry, App Services, AKS, Functions, Entra ID, Sentinel, Monitor, Key Vault, Cosmos DB, SQL, Storage, Virtual Networks, Front Door, API Management
AI & Data	Azure AI Foundry, OpenAI, Databricks, Fabric, GenAI/LLM Strategy, RAG, MLOps, Prompt Engineering, Data Pipelines, Real-time Analytics
Multi-Cloud	Microsoft Azure, AWS, Google Cloud Platform - Architecture, Migration & Governance
Infrastructure	Terraform, Bicep, ARM Templates, Kubernetes, Docker, Helm, AKS, GitHub Actions, CI/CD
Security & Governance	Zero Trust Architecture, RBAC, Azure Policy, Entra ID, Sentinel, Compliance, Landing Zones
Customer Engagement	Strategic Advisory, Executive Presentations, Architecture Design Sessions, Workshops, Customer Success Plans, Delivery Proposals
Languages	TypeScript, Python, JavaScript, Go, SQL

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Cloud Architect - AI & Multi-Cloud Strategy 2024 - Present

H&M Group, Stockholm

- Built trusted relationships with executive stakeholders as strategic technical advisor, translating business requirements into scalable cloud and AI architectures across Azure, AWS, and GCP supporting 200+ product teams globally
- Led architecture design sessions and guided delivery of enterprise AI platforms on Azure AI Foundry, AWS Bedrock, and GCP Vertex AI - designing end-to-end solutions with multi-model orchestration, auto-scaling inference, and A/B model evaluation
- Owned end-to-end technical delivery for strategic enterprise workloads, driving cloud adoption and AI transformation aligned to customer success plans across fashion retail and supply chain operations
- Delivered multi-million SEK FinOps programme - designed cost optimisation architectures reducing cloud spend by 35% through right-sizing, reserved capacity, and automated governance using Azure Policy and CAF principles
- Established cloud governance framework at enterprise scale using CAF and WAF - policies, security baselines, RBAC, landing zones, and compliance controls for 1,600+ subscriptions across multi-cloud estate
- Contributed to technical communities through mentoring, knowledge sharing, and thought leadership - authored architecture blueprints, workshops, and best-practice documentation, upskilling 8+ engineers
- Drove technical excellence using SAP LeanIX, Zachman, and TOGAF frameworks - aligning Azure workload decisions with long-term business strategy and ensuring production-scale AI readiness

Lead Software Engineer - Cloud Platform Engineering 2023 - 2024

H&M Group, Stockholm

- Engineered multi-cloud platform backbone on Azure & Google Cloud - achieving 99.9% uptime SLA for 200+ product teams, ensuring performance, security, and resilience across enterprise workloads
- Designed and built Internal Developer Platform with self-service provisioning - Azure EventGrid + Functions architecture reducing team onboarding from days to minutes
- Evaluated, benchmarked, and deployed AI/ML tools (OpenAI, Azure AI, Gemini) - shipped developer productivity solutions improving team velocity by 40%
- Conducted deep-dive architecture design sessions and Well-Architected Reviews, creating reusable patterns and repeatable IP for cross-team adoption

Senior Software Engineer - Distributed Systems & Azure 2020 - 2023

H&M Group, Stockholm

- Designed Zero Trust microservices architecture on Azure - 15+ services with sub-100ms p99 latency, demonstrating deep infrastructure, networking, and security expertise
- Built high-throughput APIs handling 50K+ RPM across distributed systems on Azure + GKE with automated scaling, rate limiting, and App Services integration
- Led CI/CD standardisation using GitHub Actions across 200+ repositories - 95% pipeline success rate, establishing DevOps best practices and accelerating Azure adoption at enterprise scale
- Resolved complex technical blockers through root cause analysis across distributed systems, improving platform reliability and developer experience

Cloud Solution Architect Consultant - FSI Data & AI 2019 - 2020

Cognizant - Ikano Bank, Stockholm

- Strategic technical advisor to a financial services client - architected migration of AML & KYC data and APIs from on-premises to a serverless, event-driven platform, reducing latency by 70%
- Designed secure, scalable data and integration architecture with Terraform IaC and cloud-native observability - handling 500K+ daily financial transactions
- Designed a scripted, rules-based automation framework for code and API policy conversion - reusable IP that cut migration delivery time by 60% through templated, repeatable tooling
- Delivered executive proof-of-concept demonstrations, shaping impactful delivery proposals and driving alignment for full cloud and data adoption
- Established CI/CD pipeline with GitHub Actions replacing legacy manual deployments - deployment frequency increased 10x

Cognizant - Volvo Cars, Gothenburg

- Served as trusted technical advisor to Volvo Cars engineering teams - designed and delivered enterprise observability platform (ELK, Grafana, Prometheus) on AKS monitoring 100+ automotive microservices
- Owned end-to-end technical delivery of CI/CD pipelines for Kubernetes clusters - reduced deployment cycle time from hours to 15 minutes across automotive software delivery
- Authored architecture documentation, runbooks, and incident response procedures - achieving 99.5% SLA compliance and providing delivery oversight across production environments
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams and partners to identify infrastructure bottlenecks, shaping delivery proposals and translating automotive requirements into optimised cloud solutions

Cloud Engineer → Cloud Solution Developer

Cognizant Technology Solutions

- Designed and delivered cloud architectures for 5+ strategic enterprise customers - end-to-end CI/CD pipelines, Docker, containerisation across diverse industry verticals in customer-facing technical roles
- Developed Cloud Management Dashboard providing real-time infrastructure visibility and cost analytics - driving measurable business impact for enterprise customers
- Won 1st place at Enterprise Cloud Game Day (200+ participants) - demonstrating deep technical expertise under production-pressure scenarios
- Provided technical guidance, mentoring, and knowledge transfer to client teams - building cloud fluency and accelerating cloud adoption across enterprise organisations

KEY SOLUTIONS & ARCHITECTURE PROJECTS

Enterprise AI Platform - Multi-Model Orchestration (H&M Group)

Designed distributed AI orchestration platform serving 200+ teams. Multi-model inference pipelines with auto-scaling, A/B evaluation, and production-scale AI readiness. Azure AI Foundry, Vertex AI, OpenAI, Python, TypeScript.

Enterprise FinOps & Cloud Governance Platform (H&M Group)

Multi-agentic AI system reducing multi-million SEK cloud spend. Automated anomaly detection, right-sizing, and governance dashboards using CAF/WAF principles across Azure, AWS, and GCP. Repeatable IP for cross-team adoption.

AML/KYC Serverless Migration - Cloud Architecture (Cognizant / Ikano Bank)

Architected full cloud migration from on-prem to serverless via a scripted, rules-based automation framework for code conversion. Functions, API Management, Terraform. 70% latency reduction, 60% faster delivery.

Rubin - AI Coding Assistant (Open Source / GitHub)

Privacy-first local AI coding assistant with 14-tool agent mode, MCP server integration, streaming chat. Demonstrates AI/ML product thinking, GitHub ecosystem expertise, and developer tooling thought leadership. TypeScript, VS Code API.

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified DevOps Engineer - Professional
- AWS Certified Developer - Associate
- Microsoft Certified Professional (MCP) - Exam 533: Azure Infrastructure
- Microsoft Certified: Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900)
- Microsoft OpenHack: AI-Powered Knowledge Mining · Containers · Security, Compliance & Identity · DevOps
- Google India Udacity Scholar

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Technology - Computer Science & Engineering

Galgotias University, Greater Noida, India

Specialisation in Cloud Computing & Virtualisation. Projects: IoT Heart Rate Monitor, Big Data Analytics.

PUBLICATIONS & THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

- I Gave an AI Agent Root Access to a Sandboxed Linux Box - AI agent sandbox experiment (Medium)
- What is Kubernetes? - Container orchestration deep-dive (FAUN / Medium)
- OpenAI & DALL-E Experimentation - AI image generation and practical applications (Medium)
- Building Apps on Google Cloud Run - Serverless deployment patterns (Medium)
- Azure DevOps is the new VSTS - Enterprise DevOps transformation (Medium)